

Cloud IT POS

How to Begin - Getting Started Guide

Production-Ready POS + Inventory + Rental Management System

IMPORTANT: Fresh Install Only - No Sample Data

This system is designed for real business use. There is NO automatic sample data.

You must create everything yourself through the Setup Wizard and Settings.

This gives you a clean, production starting point.

1. Installation (Windows)

1. Extract or clone the cloud-it-pos folder.
2. Double-click install.bat
 - It will create a venv, install dependencies, and create the 'instance' folder.
 - A desktop shortcut 'Cloud IT POS' will be created (optional).
3. Double-click start.bat to run the application.

The app will start on `http://127.0.0.1:5000`

If port 5000 is busy, edit `run.py` and change the port.

2. First Run - Setup Wizard (Mandatory)

On the very first launch (or when no users exist):

1. You will be automatically redirected to `/setup`
2. Fill in your first Branch details:
 - Branch Name, Address, TIN (mandatory for VMS), VMS UID, Phone
3. Create your Administrator account (username + strong password)
4. Click 'Complete Setup'

After setup you will be taken to the login page.

Log in with the admin credentials you just created.

Reset to Completely Fresh Install (if it already has a database)

If the app 'already has a database' from previous runs or testing and you want a true fresh start:

1. Completely stop the server (close the black console window).
2. Open PowerShell in the cloud-it-pos folder and run for the specific DB file:
`Remove-Item -Force instance\frcs_vms_pos.db`
(or `instance\yourcompany.db` etc.)
3. Run `start.bat` again, or after launch go to the Database Selector (`/choose-db`) and use 'Create a brand new database'.

The system will detect no users (in the chosen/created DB) and redirect you to the Setup Wizard with a brand new, empty database.

This is the correct and recommended way to achieve a 'fresh install' for one particular database while leaving others untouched.

2b. Multiple Databases - Choose or Create New (NEW)

Cloud IT POS now supports running several completely separate databases (e.g. different companies, branches, or test vs live).

How it works:

1. On first visit, or from the Login page, click the link 'Switch / Create Database' (or go to `/choose-db`).
2. You will see a list of all `.db` files present in the `instance/` folder.
 - Size and last-modified date are shown for each.

- The default 'frcs_vms_pos.db' is highlighted.
3. Click 'Use this database' to switch to it (session remembers your choice).
 4. Or use the 'Create a brand new database' form:
 - Type a simple name like 'mycompany' or 'branch_suva_2026'
 - Click Create & Use
 - It creates an empty .db file, initializes the full schema + minimal required seeds (tax + payments), sets it active, and sends you to login/setup for that DB.

Important:

- Everything (users, products, sales, tenants, leases, certificates, receipt layouts...) is per-database.
- To reset just one: while stopped, `Remove-Item -Force instance\thatname.db` then recreate via the selector.
- You can backup/ copy .db files safely when the app is not running.
- The top navigation bar (once logged in) always shows the current DB name + click to switch.
- Default database name can be overridden with env var FRCS_DB_NAME=other.db

3. Essential Configuration (Do This Immediately)

Go to Settings (top right, admin only).

A. Tax Rates (Critical for correct calculations)

- Create at least one active Tax Rate (e.g. Standard 15%)
- You can create multiple rates (Zero-rated, Exempt, etc.)
- Every product and rental property can be assigned its own rate.

B. Payment Methods

- Create the methods you accept: CASH, CARD, ON_ACCOUNT, etc.

C. Receipt Design (Optional but recommended)

- Set Company Name, Header/Footer text
- Upload logo (recommended for professional receipts)
- Click 'Open Visual Drag & Drop Receipt Designer' (Composer 2.5) to customize exactly which fields appear on receipts.

4. Adding Products (Inventory)

Go to Inventory in the top navigation.

Click 'Add Product':

- Barcode (highly recommended - used for scanning in POS)
- Name, SKU (optional - auto-generated if left blank)
- Selling Price (this is the VIP price the customer pays)
- Cost Price
- Assign Tax Rate (this controls VEP/VIP calculation)
- Department (highly recommended)
- Special Pricing Group (if you want bundle/quantity deals)

Tip: Use 'Bulk Update' or Excel Import for many products at once.

5. Using the POS Terminal

Click 'Open POS Terminal' from the Dashboard or main menu.

1. Select your Branch (if you have multiple)
2. Scan a product barcode or type part of the name and press Enter
3. Adjust quantities if needed
4. (Optional) Select a Debtor for on-account sales
5. Choose Payment Method

6. Click 'Complete Sale'

After the sale you can:

- Download the official FRCS PDF receipt
- View the sale details

Special features:

- Special pricing (bundles) is automatically applied when conditions are met
- Branch-specific pricing is used when configured
- Full tax breakdown per line (using the product's assigned tax rate)

6. Rental Management (New Major Feature)

Go to the 'Rental' dropdown in the top navigation.

Step 1: Create Properties

- Go to Rental > Properties
- Add Property:
 - Give it a unique Barcode (this is how you will 'scan' it in Rent Collection)
 - Set Monthly Rent
 - IMPORTANT: Choose Property Type:
 - * Residential = VEP (price is ex-tax)
 - * Commercial = VIP (price is inc-tax)
 - Optionally assign a specific Tax Rate
 - Optionally assign a current Tenant

Step 2: Create Tenants

- Go to Rental > Tenants
- Add tenant details (name, phone, etc.)
- Outstanding balance will be managed automatically

Step 3: Collect Rent (POS-style)

- Go to Rental > Rent Collection (Scan & Pay)
- This screen works almost exactly like the main POS
- Scan (or type) the Property Barcode
- It will show the tenant and suggested amount (adjusted for VEP/VIP)
- Add as 'Charge (Due Rent)' or 'Record Payment'
- Use Amount Received + Change calculation
- Complete the transaction

Tenant balances update automatically.

Charges and Payments are recorded with full tax breakdown based on property type.

7. Maintenance & Leases (Rental Add-ons)

Maintenance / Work Orders:

- Go to Rental > Maintenance / Work Orders
- Log issues reported against a property
- Track status (Open -> In Progress -> Completed)
- Record actual costs

Leases:

- Go to Rental > Leases
- Record formal lease agreements with start/end dates and terms
- Click 'Generate Monthly Charges' to automatically create rent charges for all active leases (great for recurring billing)

8. Reports & Daily Sales Summary

Daily Sales Summary (very useful):

- Shows sales grouped by date + payment method
- Clearly shows Credit Notes / Returns (negative) and Net Sales

General Reports:

- Sales by payment method, department, etc.
- Export to PDF or Excel

Access is controlled by permissions (can_view_reports, can_view_daily_sales_summary).

9. Users & Permissions (Granular Access Control)

Only Administrators can manage users.

In Settings > Users you can:

- Create new users with role (admin / manager / staff)
- Assign very specific permissions such as:
can_issue_credit_notes, can_view_daily_sales_summary,
can_manage_debtors, can_do_stock_adjustment, etc.

The navigation automatically hides options the user does not have permission for.

10. VMS Certificates & Fiscalization

Go to 'VMS Certificates'.

For each branch you can:

- Set Simulation mode (default - no real FRCS call)
- Set Real VSDC mode + enter the vsdc_base_url and receipt_sequence
- Upload a real .pfx certificate from FRCS

Use the Test Signing button to verify your certificate works.

Every sale (and credit note) is fiscalized and produces an official receipt.

11. Customizing Receipts (Composer 2.5)

In Settings > Receipt Design you can set basic header/footer/logo.

For full control click 'Open Visual Drag & Drop Composer 2.5'.

- Drag any database field (Order, Branch, Debtor, Fiscal, Totals, etc.)
- Add Free Text / Notes
- See live preview (switch between 80mm and A4)
- Save Layout

The saved layout is used for all future PDF receipts (both WeasyPrint and FPDF fallback).

*This guide is available from the Dashboard (Help card) or top navigation Help link.
For technical installation details see the INSTALL.md file included with the software.*